

Understanding the Effects of Online Classes:

A Phenomenological Study of the Mental and Physical States of Senior High School Students during the COVID-19 Pandemic.



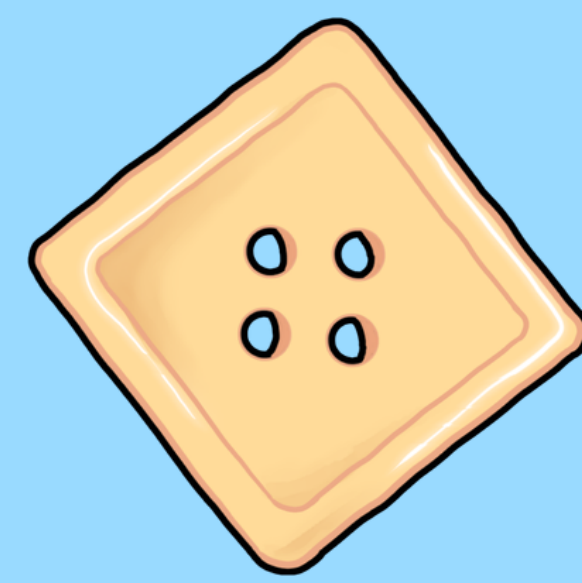
Davao Christian High School

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Introduction

The COVID-19 pandemic brought many unforeseen events and circumstances for everyone. One of the most significant changes was the online learning setup that forced students of all ages and grade levels to study from home. The key of this study is to investigate how senior high school students in Davao Christian High School (DCHS) feel about their current school life after experiencing the majority of junior high school online.



Objectives

This study aims to explain and explore the lived experiences of students and teachers in Davao Christian High School during the COVID-19 pandemic in terms of how their mental and physical wellbeing have been affected.

Methodology

This research utilized interviews in order to gather genuine and authentic data from the students themselves. The participants involved, chosen through convenience sampling, were 4 selected students from Grades 11 and 12, and 2 senior high school teachers who were present during S.Y. 2020-2022. Each participant was asked to provide a pseudonym to conceal their identity and the interviews were done based on their availability.

Results

The responses of the participants helped identify important themes in the students' experiences during the pandemic. These themes were categorized according to the questions asked: **difficulties during online distance learning, difficulties post online distance learning, and effects on health.**

Analysis

Difficulties During Online Distance Learning

- **Distractions:** Students are easily distracted by social media and technology during online classes.
- **Workload:** Students are overwhelmed by the amount of tasks brought by procrastination.
- **Lack of Motivation:** Students have a hard time finding the motivation to do school work.
- **Lack of Engagement:** Low participation and interaction in online classes.
- **Technology:** Adjusting to new technology poses challenges for both students and teachers who are less ICT literate.

Difficulties Post Online Distance Learning

- **No Difficulties:** Some students didn't face any challenges transitioning back to face-to-face classes.
- **Difficulty Adjusting to the Old Schedule:** Struggles with readjusting to early mornings and structured schedules.
- **Change in Student Personality:** Students returned with altered behaviors and habits from online learning.

Effect on Health

- **Mental Health:** Some students faced challenges with mental health due to lack of in-person interaction.
- **Physical Health:** Changes in physical health observed, including weight fluctuations and body pains.
- **No Significant Effect:** Some individuals didn't notice any major changes in their mental or physical health before, during, and after online classes.



Conclusion

Based on the findings, many factors contribute as to how and why students were affected both mentally and physically during online classes. It can be concluded that the pandemic affected people in many ways, to varying extents, and that there are a lot of experiences during that time which helped shape how students now approach their current day-to-day lives.

Recommendations

For further recommendations, future researchers are advised to take into account the number of demographics that could be made available for this research. Time constraints should also be considered as this study chose convenience sampling for data collection due to the given amount of people and time.

